BRAND HEALTH AUDIT · NOVEMBER 2026

What 1,140 reviews say three sunscreen brands must fix

Aspect-based sentiment audit of Aqualogica, Minimalist and Dot & Key, and the pack and comms moves the data supports



Dot & Key	Aqualogica	Minimalist
+27.3	−15.8	−56.7

Net Sentiment Score, −100 to +100

Saumya Singh· 1,140 Nykaa reviews · Gemini ABSA, 95% sentiment agreement with hand labels

CONSUMER DIAGNOSTIC · NET SENTIMENT SCORE BY PILLAR

Texture and skin fit decide the category; Minimalist loses on both



Pillar	Aqualogica	Dot & Key	Minimalist
Texture & Finish	+14.7	+40.3	**-66.5**
Skin Compatibility	-68.9	-35.7	**-83.2**
Overall Experience	+50.7	+71.8	+45.5
Sun Protection	-23.3	+16.4	+18.4
Packaging*	-58.3	0.0	-42.9
All pillars	**-15.8**	**+27.3**	**-56.7**

Score = (positive - negative) ÷ mentions × 100. *Packaging: 45 mentions, directional only.

53%

of all 1,913 mentions are about texture, with 17× the complaints packaging gets (534 vs 31)

82%

of skin-fit mentions are complaints: the most criticised pillar

+40.3

Dot & Key's texture score, the benchmark to protect: light, no white cast. Its one gap: pilling under makeup (30).

Source: Power BI brand health dashboard · 1,913 aspect mentions from 1,140 reviews, 380 per brand

MINIMALIST · PROBLEM AND PACK FIX

Minimalist reaches the wrong skin; the pack must say who it's for



77.1%

of its 658 mentions are complaints (all brands: 56.2%); 123 of 380 reviews are high churn risk

TOP COMPLAINTS · MENTIONS

Greasy Oily Feel	118
White Cast Issue	83
Unsuitable For Oily Skin	33

> *"It's good for normal skin. But not for oily or combination skin."*

BEFORE

MINIMALIST

SUNSCREEN

SPF 50

PA++++

SPF claims only

AFTER

Dry & normal skin

Matte ● ● ● ● ● Dewy

SUNSCREEN

SPF 50

PA++++

Oily skin? Try [matte SKU] →

Same badge on the first listing image on Blinkit, Zepto, Nykaa and Amazon, legible at 150 × 150 px. White cast (83) and pilling (48) go to an R&D texture brief.

Source: Minimalist, 380 reviews · quote verbatim · pack is a concept mock-up, not brand artwork

AQUALOGICA · DEEP DIVE AND INTERVENTION

Aqualogica's skin reactions are breaking trust



34.5%

of its 380 reviews carry high churn risk (131): the highest of the three brands

MENTIONS · HIGH-CHURN REVIEWS

Causes Breakouts

47 · 46

Skin Darkening

44 · 25

Skin Irritation Burning

29 · 28

1. **Root-cause the reactions (R&D and QA)**
   Check batches and the formula behind breakout and irritation reports. Test whether "darkening" is a reaction or tanning from too little product.

2. **Fix the claims and the pack**
   Add "patch test before first use" and skin-type guidance. Run non-comedogenic testing before making that claim.

3. **Close the loop on listings**
   Reply to every reaction review with a care route; add dermatologist content on how much to apply and when to reapply.

"This product for 500, I have almost spent my 4k to the doctor. Choose wisely."

Source: Aqualogica, 380 reviews · bar label = negative mentions · second number = high-churn reviews citing it

DOT & KEY · PROTECT AND POLISH

Dot & Key leads on texture; pilling is its one gap



+27.3

Net Sentiment, the best of the three, and the lowest churn risk: 80 of 380 reviews (21.1%)

BUYERS LOVE · MENTIONS

Lightweight Texture	81
No White Cast	61
Quick Absorption	43

BUYERS DISLIKE · MENTIONS

Pilling Under Makeup	30
Greasy Oily Feel	28
White Cast Issue	24

1 Protect the texture

Don’t change the base formula. Lead every Nykaa listing and ad with what buyers praise: lightweight, no white cast.

2 Fix pilling with usage guidance

“It peels off when reapplying,” one buyer writes. Add “let it set before makeup” and “pat, don’t rub, to reapply” to pack and listing.

3 Check makeup compatibility (R&D)

Test it under common primers and foundations. If pilling persists, brief a tweak that keeps the light feel.

Source: Dot & Key, 380 Nykaa reviews · bar lengths on one scale · quote verbatim

WHY IT MATTERS

These fixes target 6 in 10 of the customers we're likely to lose



1,140
Nykaa reviews analysed

→

334
are likely to stop buying (29%)

→

198
complain about a problem these fixes target

Where they are

Aqualogica 92 · Minimalist 70 · Dot & Key 36

If we win back half of them

Customers likely to stop buying fall from **29% to 21%** of reviewers.

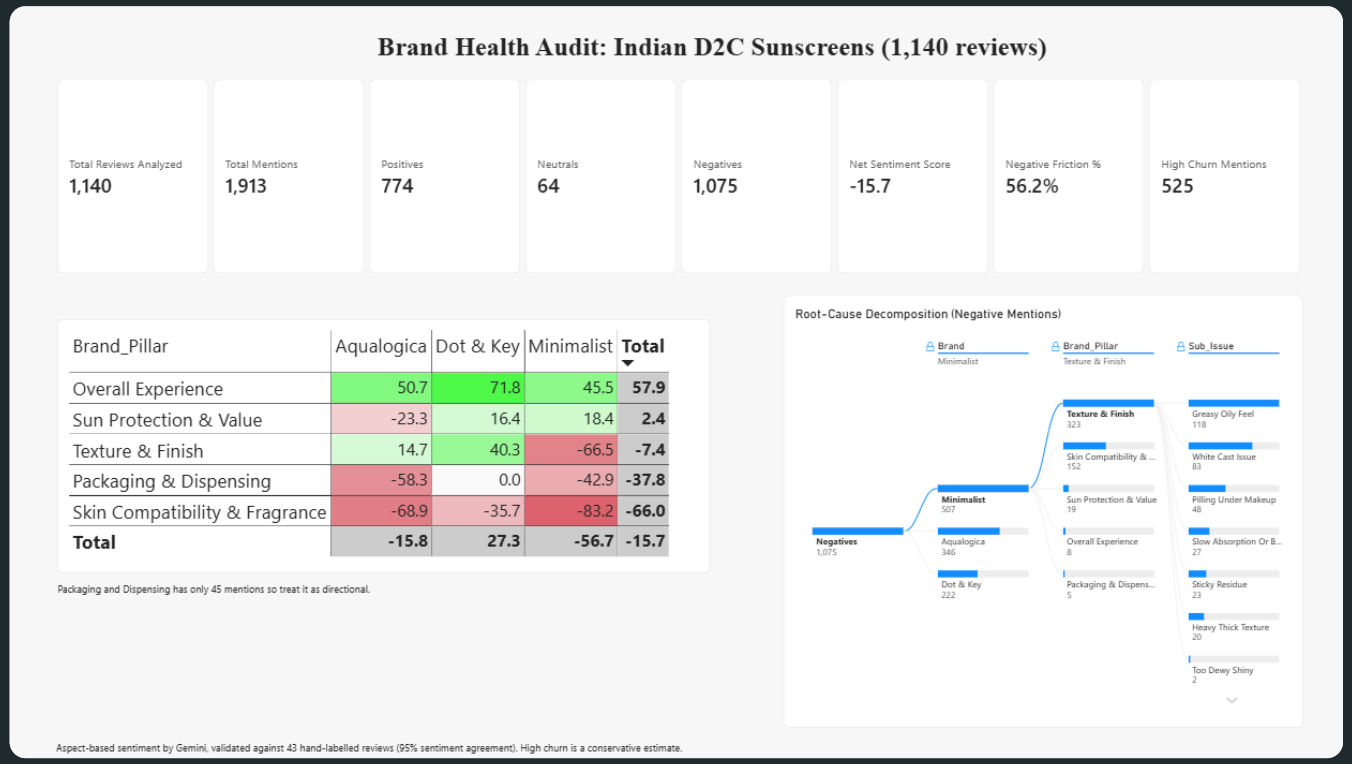
How we prove it

Test the new pack image against the current one on Nykaa and compare 90-day repeat purchases.

"Likely to stop buying" = won't rebuy, returned it, warned others or had a reaction · likely undercounted

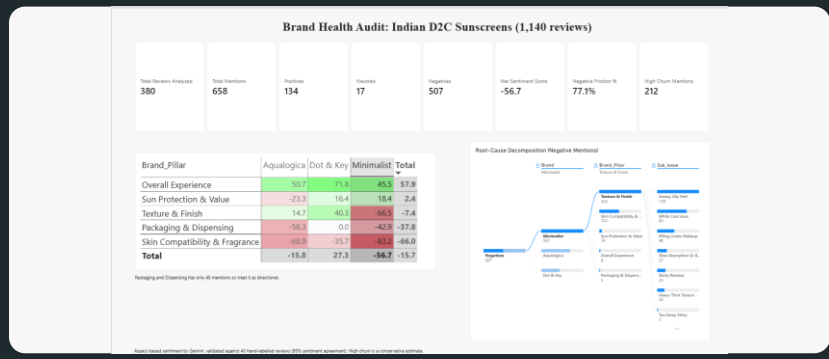
APPENDIX · THE EVIDENCE

The Power BI dashboard behind every number

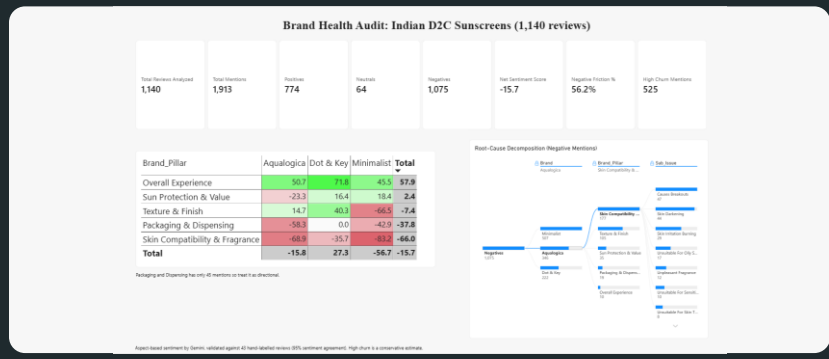


Full view: KPI cards, competitive matrix, root-cause tree

Filtered to Minimalist



Drill-down: Aqualogica → Skin Compatibility



Power BI Desktop · 1,913 aspect rows · 95% sentiment agreement with 43 hand-labelled reviews